

The once in 100 years pandemic might have hastened digital evolution. Every aspect of our life as we have known it in the past 50 years is already changing. In fact, the next 20 years is going to see even more changes than the previous 200. In the era of unpredictability, we have accelerated the adoption of various technologies, however we need to brace ourselves and look forward to technology trends and inflection points that will power us into the future.

AI will power everything and be everywhere. Yes, I mean it. Computation is on track to become exponentially cheaper, faster and more reliable with every passing year. Driven by rapid advances in nano tech and networking speeds, this will bring AI in everything. Consumer behavior was once touted as the reason why e-commerce was slow to pick up, but over the last 15 months the world is very comfortable buying everything online. One study puts the extent of e-commerce growth in 20-21 at 44% over the previous year! Soon we

could trust AI to make all regular, mundane and non-experiential purchases. We will only monitor as AI takes over that role as well.

While mundane tasks will be done by AI, most things that are experiential would be powered by Virtual Reality (VR). For instance, why go to a doctor's office for non-critical visits when you can just schedule a time and he meets you virtually? Bluetooth Low Energy (BLE) devices could communicate your vitals and readings in real time to the doctor, and she'd send over a prescription for medicines directly to your online pharmacy which would deliver it in under an hour.

Our political system is going to have to get involved at some point, because if you're meeting doctors virtually anyway, do they have to be doctors from your country? There will also likely be a drive to standardize all medical records and thresholds for medical measurements worldwide, so that there is global compatibility. Also, some health care treatments will

towards measuring and reporting low code + no code numbers as a key metric for linear revenue models. The ITES sector which employs lots of BPO/KPO staff also would have rethought their model to account for the emergence of AI bots. Not just AI bots on the enterprise side and on the side of corporations, most customers will also have delegated their tasks to AI bots which they would have bought as a service to save time. So, it is in reality, AI bots interacting with AI bots.

In a recent interview Microsoft CEO Satya Nadella emphasized on the need of thinking beyond windows. In October 2020 Microsoft adopted Android for the Surface Duo. With this they tried to communicate that the OS no longer is prime, and it's all about the app model and experience. Organizations like Microsoft are focusing heavily on fluid framework technology, since 2014 Microsoft has shifted its impetus to 'cloud first mobile first' and this framework is an extension of that, similarly other product organizations like Oracle which have been traditionally focusing on products are now focusing heavily on cloud and SaaS.

The future will see the line between product and services diminish, with cloud and hyperscalers being mainstream both products and services will amalgamate, and a fusion of offerings is expected to emerge which will have elements of both products and services.

Hyper Personalization is probably a concept which will be discussed by all industries – Retail, Hi Tech or Manufacturing. Servicing this need is going to be the most important ask of the IT industry. Most services or apps will have the ability to be launched from concept to production in less than 72 hrs. Today, we are struggling to fulfill stated needs and preferences, the next 20 years will not only satisfy stated preferences but also unstated preferences in a truly hyper personalized manner. The popular MBA marketing books will have to be rewritten for every aspect of the 4 Ps – Product, Price, Place and Promotion, all of these would be Hyper personal.

The technological journey to 2041 is going to be exhilarating. 🚀

COLUMN | KARTHIK BALASUBRAMANIAN

2041: The future is bright and experiential



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be proactive instead of reactive, and healthcare will change from sickness care to wellness care.

5G will fast-track our journey to a more connected world. Some research reports suggest that we will be able to realize the full potential of 5G only by 2035. Expect computing and storage to not be on premises (home or office), as cloud services will be much cheaper and more reliable, and more importantly, accessible to you anywhere.

Being the leader at the best product engineering services company, I want to devote the next few topics to the Hi-Tech Industry.

This is one area which is going to see explosive growth from the current USD 12-13B global market in 2020 to ~USD 45B in 2025 and >USD 150B in 2030. There is likely to be a great thrust